



PROJECT CAPABILITY BRIEF

How Bernd Bieker solves your most critical IT challenges

Bernd Bieker, Dr.-Ing.

Senior Freelance
Consultant

info@berndbieker.de

The following four scenarios reflect the most common challenges my clients face when navigating complex IT programs in regulated and capital-intensive industries. In each case, I illustrate the situation, the structured approach I apply, and the outcomes clients can expect. These are not hypothetical -- they reflect real program experience accumulated over 25+ years at the helm of transformative IT initiatives at Sandoz, Novartis and other leading organizations.

Client Scenario 1 | IT Carve-out & Separation

"We are being divested. Our parent company gives us 14 months to separate all IT systems. We have never done this before."

THE CLIENT CHALLENGE	HOW I ADDRESS IT	MEASURABLE OUTCOMES
A mid-size pharmaceutical company has been carved out from a global parent. It now faces the task of separating from shared ERP, infrastructure and security services -- across 30+ countries -- while maintaining uninterrupted commercial and manufacturing operations. The internal IT team lacks carve-out experience, vendor contracts are entangled, and the TSA clock is ticking. Proof of concept: Bernd led program ORBIT at Sandoz (2023 - 2025), separating IT landscape from mother company.	- Rapid diagnostic: map all shared services, TSA scope and Day-1 exit requirements across all workstreams - Establish a program management structure with clear accountability: IT Separation Management Office - Design a step-by-step M&A IT playbook tailored to the specific regulatory and operational environment (GxP, serialization, ERP) - Run TSA negotiation support and shadow IT readiness tracking in parallel - Implement weekly steering rhythm with ExCom-level escalation path and structured risk log - Drive Day-1 Readiness validation: cutover rehearsals, fallback plans, go/no-go criteria	✓ Day-1 readiness achieved on schedule ✓ Zero critical findings in external audit ✓ TSA exits on time and within budget ✓ Reusable playbook retained by client for future transactions ✓ No material disruption to GxP manufacturing or commercial supply Multi-100M€ program accountability 1,000+ Apps / 50+ Countries separation scope 0 Major Findings audit result

Client Scenario 2 | OT/ICS Cybersecurity -- IEC 62443-based Program Delivery

"Our Board has flagged OT/ICS as a critical risk. With NIS-2 now in force, we need an audit-ready program -- and we do not know where to start."

THE CLIENT CHALLENGE	HOW I ADDRESS IT	MEASURABLE OUTCOMES
A pharmaceutical or energy company operates manufacturing sites with legacy OT/ICS environments. Following board-level risk escalation and new regulatory pressure (including NIS-2 in energy/utilities and ongoing GxP requirements in pharma), the CISO and COO need to build a credible,	- Baseline assessment: inventory all OT/ICS assets, network topology and current security posture across all sites - Gap analysis against IEC 62443 and NIST CSF; risk-ranked remediation roadmap with clear owner accountability	✓ Positive internal / external audit outcome ✓ OT security program embedded in capex and change process ✓ Regulatory compliance posture advanced (GxP, NIS-2-ready methodology)

audit-ready programme -- without disrupting production. Proof of concept: Bernd led program TOPAZ at Novartis (2017-2022), securing 60+ global manufacturing locations aligned to IEC 62443 and NIST CSF. NIS-2 did not yet exist at that time -- but the methodology is directly applicable to current NIS-2 compliance needs.	- Hands-on OT security architecture design: network segmentation, controlled access, ring-fencing of legacy systems - Define and embed cybersecurity standards into change control and capital expenditure processes (sustain over time) - Align program with Quality Assurance and Regulatory Affairs to ensure GxP / validation compatibility - Prepare and accompany internal and external audits; design C-level and Board reporting dashboards	✓ Board and regulator confidence established ✓ Zero unplanned production disruption during programme execution IEC 62443 primary framework 60+ Sites secured (2017-2022) GxP-validated execution methodology
---	--	---

Client Scenario 3 | IT Portfolio Governance & Transformation Office

"Our IT portfolio has grown faster than our governance. No single view of spend, conflicting priorities, and the Board has lost confidence."

THE CLIENT CHALLENGE	HOW I ADDRESS IT	MEASURABLE OUTCOMES
Across a period of sustained growth and organizational change, a large organization's IT landscape has grown fragmented. There is no unified portfolio view, no consistent investment prioritization framework, and IT leadership struggles to communicate value to the CFO and Board. Multiple program offices report in silos. Transformation initiatives stall due to unclear ownership and contested budget. Proof of concept: Bernd led group-wide IT project portfolio management at E.ON (2010-2015), governing ~900 projects annually and a ~EUR 200M IT investment portfolio, including C-level board reporting and cross-divisional budget reallocation.	- Establish a single IT Portfolio Management Office: scope, process design, tooling and staffing model - Define a prioritization framework aligned to corporate strategy: value scoring, risk weighting, dependency mapping - Implement a unified program reporting structure with consistent KPIs up to Board level - Rationalize the project landscape: stop/pause/accelerate decisions based on portfolio analysis - Design the target IT operating model including governance forums, RACI and decision rights - Coach and enable the internal IT leadership team to sustain the model independently	✓ Single source of truth for IT portfolio established ✓ Board reporting credibility restored within 90 days ✓ EUR 100M+ portfolio brought under structured governance ✓ Alignment between IT investment and business strategy achieved ✓ Internal team capable of operating model independently post-engagement EUR 100M+ portfolio under governance (reference) 90 days to first Board-ready view C-Suite direct reporting restored

Client Scenario 4 | Chief of Staff & IT Strategy

"Our CIO is building the technology function while running live programs. We need someone to hold the operational backbone together — strategy, budget and leadership alignment."

THE CLIENT CHALLENGE	HOW I ADDRESS IT	MEASURABLE OUTCOMES
A newly structured technology leadership team is under dual pressure: running complex transformation programs while simultaneously building its own governance structures, financial framework and operating model. The CIO carries full external accountability without an internal operational backbone. IT strategy is undefined at function level, budget tracking is fragmented across the portfolio, and board-level reporting lacks the structure and consistency that executive credibility demands. Proof of concept: At Sandoz (2022–2025), Bernd held a dual mandate — leading the IT M&A separation program while acting as de-facto Chief of Staff to the CTO: defining IT strategy, designing the operating model, building financial tracking for the full technology organization, aligning the leadership team and preparing board presentations.	- Define or sharpen the IT strategy: articulate the function's mandate, priorities and direction in board-ready terms aligned to business objectives - Design the technology operating model: leadership structure, governance forums, decision rights, RACI and collaboration rhythms - Establish financial tracking for the full technology portfolio: actuals vs. plan, reforecast cycles, variance commentary for CFO and Board - Build a leadership operating rhythm: cadence design, agenda governance, cross-functional dependency management and escalation paths - Prepare CIO-level board and ExCom presentations: structured narrative, relevant KPIs, clear ask and context for non-technical audiences - Identify and close alignment gaps within the leadership team: shared priorities, clear accountability and decision ownership	✓ IT strategy defined, documented and endorsed at Board or ExCom level ✓ Full technology budget under structured financial governance ✓ Leadership team operating in a consistent, productive rhythm ✓ Board and ExCom reporting delivered on time with clear narrative ✓ CIO able to focus on external stakeholders and strategic decisions Full IT budget under governance Board-ready IT strategy Leadership rhythm established within 30 days

Why Bernd Bieker?

Senior expertise -- personally delivered. No junior teams, no overhead. You get a leader who has run multi-100M€ programs, secured 60+ manufacturing sites, governed a 200M€ IT portfolio and served as Chief of Staff to a CTO holding strategy, budget and leadership alignment together. Available as strategic advisor, board-level technology contributor, or interim executive (VP/C-level) -- applying that experience directly to your challenge.

Next Step

Let us discuss your situation in a no-obligation 60-minute call. I will give you a frank assessment of your challenge and how I would approach it.

✉ info@berndbieker.de | ☎ +49 15678 338870